

ASSGINEMENT:

Social Issue: Limited Access to Healthcare in the Philippines

Rationale for Selection: I chose limited access to healthcare as my social issue because it is a critical crisis in the Philippines, where far too many lives are lost due to a lack of health education and inadequate medical access.

Due to systemic poverty, many Filipinos simply do not have the financial means to afford private hospital consultations or basic medical treatments. This financial barrier often leads to a mindset where health is deprioritized until it is too late. People are forced to endure illnesses, waiting in long lines for free medical assistance that often arrives too slowly to save them.

Furthermore, improving healthcare access is vital for public safety. When individuals in a community cannot get treated, illnesses go unchecked, increasing the risk of community transmission. As we witnessed during the COVID-19 pandemic, an unaddressed health gap can easily lead to the mutation and rapid spread of dangerous viruses.

ACTIVITY 2:

As a future Information Technology (IT) professional, my responsibility extends beyond writing complex code and managing servers; I can actively contribute to resolving critical social issues by bridging the gap in the healthcare sector. To address the financial constraints and limited medical access faced by underprivileged Filipinos, I intend to develop "eMed-Tech," a free, offline medical education assistance platform that does not require mobile data or load to access. This platform will empower users with easy-to-understand information on disease prevention, health improvement, and proper medication usage, while also using mobile location services to help users locate nearby hospitals and schedule quick online appointments. By eliminating the need for expensive travel and long walk-in lines, eMed-Tech demonstrates how IT innovation can support the healthcare industry in saving lives and making medical assistance accessible to everyone, regardless of their socioeconomic status.